COLLEGE CLUB HUB

Product Requirements Document (PRD)

A simple, student-friendly website that brings club recruitment, campus events, deadlines, and opportunities into one calm dashboard.

Product concept	One reliable place for students to discover clubs, track event dates, and avoid missing opportunities buried in email.
Primary users	First-year students, club members, club coordinators, and student-affairs administrators.
Design direction	Bright, welcoming accents balanced with soothing backgrounds, clear labels, generous spacing, and minimal clutter.
Document status	Initial product brief for planning and prototyping. Campus-specific policies and integrations are to be confirmed.

Working name: College Club Hub (rename to match your college branding).

1. Executive Summary

College Club Hub is a clean, easy-to-use college website that centralizes club recruitment announcements, event information, application deadlines, and reminders. Instead of relying on crowded email inboxes and scattered messages, students can open one dashboard to see what is happening, what is coming next, and what action they need to take.

The experience should be approachable enough for a first-year student who has never used a campus portal. Keep the main tasks obvious, the language plain, and the number of steps low.

2. Problem Statement

Club recruitment notices and event updates often arrive through email, making important opportunities easy to overlook. Students may miss sign-up windows, event timings, venue changes, or application deadlines. Information can be scattered across messages and channels, and there may be no single, dependable view of upcoming campus activities.

3. Product Goals

• Give students one central place to find club recruitments, events, workshops, and deadlines.

• Make upcoming events and urgent deadlines visible at a glance.

• Offer a simple calendar with clear event markers and useful filters.

• Let students save opportunities and receive reminders before important dates.

• Allow authorized club coordinators or administrators to publish and update announcements without technical knowledge.

• Create a welcoming, mobile-friendly interface that feels calm rather than crowded.

4. Non-Goals for the First Version

• Replacing every college communication channel or email system.

• Building a complex social network, chat platform, or club-management suite.

• Automated college-wide email/calendar integrations before access and permissions are confirmed.

• Publicly exposing private student information or application data.

5. Target Users & Main Needs

User	Needs	What success looks like
First-year student	Understand what clubs exist, what is open for recruitment, and what is happening soon.	Can find an opportunity and its deadline without asking someone for help.
Returning student	Track events, workshops, and sign-up dates across clubs.	Can quickly filter, save, and revisit relevant events.
Club coordinator	Post accurate recruitment details and update event information.	Can publish an announcement using a short, guided form.
Administrator	Review posts, manage access, and keep information trustworthy.	Can approve, edit, archive, or remove content.

6. Information Architecture

• **Home / Dashboard:** welcome message, next event, deadlines coming soon, saved items, and a short list of recommended or recently added opportunities.

• **Events:** searchable list of events with date, time, location, host club, category, and registration link.

• **Calendar:** monthly and agenda views; event markers; filters by club, category, and event type; click an event to see details.

• **Clubs:** searchable directory with club descriptions, interest areas, recruitment status, and official contact/social links.

• **Recruitment:** open applications, eligibility, required materials, deadline, selection steps, and application link.

• **Saved:** bookmarked events and recruitments.

• **Notifications:** reminders and updates the student has opted into.

• **Admin / Club dashboard:** role-based forms to create, edit, submit, and manage posts.

7. Functional Requirements

7.1 Authentication and Roles

• Provide a welcoming login page with college branding, a clear sign-in form, password visibility toggle, and helpful validation messages.

• Include password reset and a visible route to request or create an account if campus policy allows it.

• If supported by the college, offer college email sign-in or single sign-on; do not assume this integration exists until confirmed.

• Support role-based permissions: Student, Club Coordinator, and Administrator. Students must not be able to publish official announcements.

• Include sign out and basic account/profile settings. Never show passwords in plain text or store them insecurely.

7.2 Dashboard

• Use a clear greeting and a small set of summary cards, such as Upcoming Events, Open Recruitments, and Deadlines This Week.

• Show the next few events in chronological order and highlight deadlines that are close.

• Make the primary actions obvious: Browse Events, Explore Clubs, View Calendar, and Saved Items.

• Include friendly empty states (for example, “Nothing saved yet — explore clubs to get started”) rather than blank panels.

• Avoid dense data tables, excessive widgets, auto-playing content, and unnecessary animations.

7.3 Calendar and Event Details

• Provide month and agenda/list views, with clear markers on days that have events.

• Show event title, date, start/end time, venue or online link, host club, category, description, registration link, and last-updated time.

• Allow users to filter by club, event category, and date range; provide a clear way to reset filters.

• Clicking a calendar item opens a readable event detail panel or page.

• Support event changes or cancellation labels so students do not rely on outdated information.

• Display dates and times in the college's configured time zone.

7.4 Recruitment Listings

• Each listing should show club name, recruitment status, opening and closing dates, eligibility, required documents/tasks, process steps, and application link.

• Clearly distinguish “Open,” “Closing soon,” “Closed,” and “Coming soon.” Do not rely on color alone; include text labels.

• Allow students to save a recruitment and optionally set a reminder before its deadline.

• Expired listings should be archived or visibly marked closed instead of appearing as active opportunities.

7.5 Publishing and Content Management

• Use a short, guided form with required fields, helpful examples, and inline validation.

• Allow authorized users to save drafts, preview, submit for approval, edit, and archive posts.

• Record who published or last edited a post and when it was updated.

• Provide an approval queue if college policy requires admin review.

• Validate dates and links, and warn users when a deadline is earlier than an event date or a required field is missing.

7.6 Reminders and Notifications

• Let students opt into reminders for saved events and recruitment deadlines.

• Start with in-site notifications; email or push notifications can be added after consent, delivery, and college integration requirements are confirmed.

• Avoid sending duplicate reminders. Let students manage notification preferences and turn reminders off.

• Show the source and date of important updates so students can judge whether information is current.

8. UX and Visual Design

Design principle: “clear first, cheerful second.” Use bright accents to make actions and event categories easy to spot, while keeping most surfaces light and soothing. Every screen should have a clear visual hierarchy and work well on a phone.

Suggested color palette

Use	Color	Hex	Guidance
Primary	Deep blue	#2563EB	Main buttons, links, active navigation
Accent	Fresh teal	#14B8A6	Success, selected calendar accents
Highlight	Warm yellow	#FBBF24	Deadlines and attention, sparingly
Background	Soft off-white	#F8FAFC	Main page background
Surface	White	#FFFFFF	Cards and forms
Text	Slate	#1E293B	Primary text and headings
Secondary	Muted slate	#64748B	Supporting text and metadata

• Use a clean sans-serif font, readable type sizes, high contrast, rounded cards, subtle borders/shadows, and consistent spacing.

• Use icons with text labels; do not make users guess what an icon means.

• Keep navigation short: Dashboard, Events, Calendar, Clubs, Saved.

• Use color consistently for event categories, but pair colors with labels or icons for accessibility.

• Use a responsive layout: compact navigation on mobile, comfortable content width on desktop.

• Keep motion subtle and optional. Avoid flashing, cluttered gradients, or too many competing bright colors.

9. Example User Flows

Student finds an event: Log in → Dashboard → select upcoming event → view details → save event or open registration link → optionally enable reminder.

Student tracks recruitment: Open Clubs or Recruitment → filter for “Open” → open a listing → review deadline and requirements → save listing → set reminder.

Coordinator publishes an event: Sign in → Club Dashboard → Add Event → complete guided form → preview → submit for approval or publish according to permissions → edit if details change.

10. Login Page Requirements

• Simple centered card with college logo/name, a short welcome line, and no distracting marketing content.

• Fields: college email or username, password, show/hide password control, and a clear Sign In button.

• Links: Forgot Password and (if enabled) Create Account / Request Access.

• Helpful errors that explain how to recover; preserve the email field after an error.

• Optional college single sign-on button only if supported.

• Include accessible labels, keyboard navigation, visible focus states, and mobile-friendly sizing.

11. Non-Functional Requirements

• **Usability:** A new student should be able to find the next event or an open recruitment in under a minute without training.

• **Accessibility:** Aim for WCAG 2.2 AA practices, including contrast, keyboard access, semantic headings, form labels, and non-color status cues.

• **Performance:** Common pages should load quickly on typical campus Wi-Fi and mobile data; optimize images and avoid unnecessary scripts.

• **Responsive design:** Support modern desktop, tablet, and mobile browsers.

• **Security:** Use secure authentication, role checks, input validation, protected admin routes, and least-privilege access.

• **Privacy:** Collect only necessary student data; do not expose private applications or contact details publicly.

• **Reliability:** Show clear loading, error, and empty states; prevent accidental duplicate submissions.

12. Suggested Data Model

Entity	Key fields
User	id, name, college_email, role, notification_preferences, created_at
Club	id, name, description, category, contact_link, recruitment_status
Event	id, title, description, start_at, end_at, venue, club_id, category, registration_url, status, updated_at
Recruitment	id, club_id, title, opens_at, deadline, eligibility, requirements, application_url, status
SavedItem	id, user_id, item_type, item_id, created_at
Reminder	id, user_id, item_type, item_id, remind_at, channel, status
ContentAudit	id, author_id, item_type, item_id, action, timestamp

13. MVP Scope and Priorities

Priority	Feature	Reason
P0 — Must have	Login and role permissions; dashboard; event list/detail; calendar; club directory; recruitment listings; admin/coordinator publishing; responsive layout.	Delivers the core promise: one place to find opportunities and deadlines.
P1 — Should have	Saved items; deadline labels; in-site reminders; search and filters; approval workflow; audit trail.	Makes the experience more useful and keeps information trustworthy.
P2 — Later	College SSO; email/push reminders; calendar export; integrations with official college systems; analytics.	Depends on campus systems, policy, and technical access.

14. Acceptance Criteria

• A student can sign in and reach the dashboard without confusing steps.

• The dashboard shows upcoming events and near deadlines in a clear order.

• A student can switch between calendar and agenda/list views and open event details.

• A student can search or filter clubs, events, and recruitments.

• A student can identify whether a recruitment is open or closed without opening every listing.

• An authorized coordinator can submit an event or recruitment using a guided form.

• Unauthorized users cannot create, edit, or approve official posts.

• Event updates and cancellations are visible, and outdated recruitments are clearly marked.

• The website remains usable on mobile and with keyboard navigation.

15. Success Metrics

• Opportunity discovery: percentage of students who view an event or recruitment detail after visiting the dashboard.

• Deadline awareness: number of saved opportunities and opted-in reminders.

• Engagement: weekly active student users and repeat visits during recruitment periods.

• Content freshness: percentage of listings with a valid deadline, current status, and recent update.

• Ease of use: short usability test completion rate for “find the next event” and “find an open recruitment.”

• Missed-opportunity feedback: student-reported reduction in missed events or deadlines.

16. Risks and Open Questions

• Who is allowed to publish official club information, and does every post require approval?

• Will students sign in with college email, existing campus SSO, or accounts created by an administrator?

• Where will event and recruitment data come from at launch, and who keeps it updated?

• Are email reminders allowed, and what consent or campus policies apply?

• Which time zone, academic calendar, branding, and accessibility requirements should be used?

• How will the site handle false, duplicate, outdated, or cancelled announcements?

17. Copy-Paste Prompt for an AI Website Builder

Use the following prompt with an AI coding assistant or website builder. Adjust the college name, logo, and technology stack as needed.

Build a responsive website called “College Club Hub” for a college community. Its purpose is to bring club recruitment notices, campus events, workshops, and deadlines into one simple place so students do not miss important opportunities buried in email. The website must be extremely easy for a first-year student with no technical experience. Prioritize clarity, friendly language, and low cognitive load over adding many features.

VISUAL STYLE: Use a bright but soothing palette: deep blue #2563EB for primary actions, teal #14B8A6 for positive accents, warm yellow #FBBF24 for occasional deadline highlights, soft off-white #F8FAFC page backgrounds, white cards, and slate text #1E293B. Use a clean sans-serif font, generous whitespace, rounded cards, subtle borders/shadows, accessible contrast, clear text labels with icons, and responsive layouts. Avoid clutter, crowded widgets, excessive gradients, and unnecessary animation.

PAGES: (1) Login page with college branding, email/username, password, show/hide password, Sign In, Forgot Password, and optional Create Account/Request Access and college SSO only if supported. (2) Student dashboard with a friendly greeting, summary cards for Upcoming Events, Open Recruitments, and Deadlines This Week; next events; closing-soon opportunities; saved items; and obvious shortcuts. (3) Events list with search and filters. (4) Calendar page with month and agenda views, marked event dates, filters by club/category, and clickable event details. (5) Clubs directory with descriptions and recruitment status. (6) Recruitment detail pages showing eligibility, required materials, opening date, deadline, selection steps, and application link. (7) Saved items and notification preferences. (8) Role-protected club coordinator/admin dashboard for creating, editing, previewing, submitting, approving, publishing, and archiving announcements.

FUNCTIONALITY: Make navigation simple: Dashboard, Events, Calendar, Clubs, Saved. Use clear status labels such as Open, Closing Soon, Closed, Cancelled, and Coming Soon; never communicate status by color alone. Let students save events and recruitments and opt into reminders. Sort events chronologically. Validate forms and links. Show loading, error, and empty states with helpful text. Show the last-updated date for listings. Protect publishing and admin actions with role-based permissions. Never expose private student application data. Use secure authentication and do not invent a real college SSO integration; clearly mark any integration that requires setup.

CONTENT AND DATA: Create realistic sample clubs and events clearly marked as demo content. Use data entities for Users, Clubs, Events, Recruitments, Saved Items, and Reminders. Include event title, description, date/time, venue or online link, host club, category, registration link, status, and updated date. Recruitment listings must include deadline, eligibility, requirements, and application URL. Make dates and time zones consistent.

QUALITY: Build mobile-first and desktop-responsive screens, accessible form labels, keyboard navigation, visible focus states, readable contrast, and friendly validation. Keep the dashboard clean and calm, with the most urgent deadlines visible near the top. Do not add chat, social feeds, or unrelated features. If backend, authentication, database, email, or calendar integrations are unavailable, build a clear front-end prototype and document exactly what still needs configuration. Deliver the working pages, reusable components, sample data, and concise setup instructions.

18. Recommended Build Sequence

• First: create wireframes for Login, Dashboard, Calendar, Event Detail, Recruitment Detail, and Coordinator Form.

• Second: build the responsive front end using sample data and validate the flow with 3–5 students, including first-year students.

• Third: add authentication, database, role permissions, and content approval.

• Fourth: add reminders and any approved campus integrations after confirming access and privacy requirements.

• Before launch: test mobile screens, keyboard access, deadlines, cancellation states, role permissions, and content ownership.